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			Page	Page 1 of 18

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(9A) Abstract Cultural mapping of the traditional healing systems, rituals, and beliefs is essential in the preservation of the intangible cultural heritage of Capiz concerning nature and the universe. This study focuses on mapping these practices, employing a phenomenological ethnographic approach through fieldworks, observations, and interviews with the key informants who were chosen based on the set inclusion criteria. The study reveals that Capisnon has different traditional healing systems, rituals, and beliefs handed down to the next generations and still exists today. It was also found that these practices have historical, aesthetic, scientific, social, socio-economic, socio-political, and spiritual significance. Oral transmission and actual observation through non-formal education are the safeguarding measures taken to sustain these practices, which show the resiliency of the people at the community level. Also, identification, documentation, and research like this are essential for its preservation. However, these are either at risk or can be lost because the younger generations show less interest in adapting their knowledge and skills due to modernization and external influences. It is recommended that the LGUs shall create a comprehensive framework for the protection and inclusion of these practices in the textbooks that the teachers may utilize in teaching social science subjects and other related fields.		
(9B) Keywords <i>Cultural Mapping, Traditional Healing Systems, Rituals, Beliefs, Cultural Heritage, Phenomenological Ethnography</i>		

(10) Introduction

Cultural mapping is defined as “an approach used to identify, record, and use cultural resources and activities for building communities, where communities map what is important to them.” (Cook and Taylor. A Contemporary Guide to Cultural Mapping. An ASEAN-Australia Perspective).

Republic Act No. 10066, or the National Heritage Act of 2009, is an act providing for the protection and conservation of the national cultural heritage, strengthening the National Commission for Culture and the Arts (NCCA) and its affiliated cultural agencies, and for other purposes of jurisdiction.

In 2021, Senate Loren B. Legarda filed Senate Bill (SB) 622, An Act Amending the RA 10066 law to integrate cultural mapping at all levels of our government. This bill, which is currently being institutionalized in Congress, also seeks to mandate LGUs to conduct a comprehensive cultural mapping of their areas.

Following this direction, the Department of Interior and Local Government (DILG) issued a directive that pushed for the cultural mapping of community/barangay cultural resources to foster identity formation and pride of place and boost tourism potential (Seal of Good Local Governance).

Through the Panay-Guimaras Cultural Mapping Program, Capiz State University was able to document the cultural heritage present in the 16 different municipalities and 1 component city of the Province of Capiz. As part of it, the traditional healing practices, rituals, and beliefs were also documented to preserve this intangible knowledge and practice of Capisnon concerning nature and the universe.

Thus, this study focuses on the documentation and mapping of the traditional healing systems, rituals, and beliefs; to understand their significance in terms of historical, aesthetic, scientific, social, socio-economic, socio-political, and spiritual; and to document the safeguarding measures taken to conserve these intangible cultural heritage for sustainable development.

(11) Materials and Methods or Methodology

Research Design:

A phenomenological ethnography approach was used in this study, which primarily aimed to map the traditional knowledge system of the Capisnon, particularly their traditional healing systems, rituals, and beliefs, through fieldwork, observation, and interviews. A phenomenological ethnography interrogates the approach of simply studying a particular group of people in a particular place at a particular time (Gabay, 2015). It includes the hidden voices of the research

participants when deriving meaning from contexts to which traditional ethnography would not afford equal importance (Li, 2020).

Participants of the Study

Purposive sampling was used to select the participants of this study by intentionally selecting specific individuals based on predefined criteria and the researcher's judgment using the three (3) generation test of Manuel (1955) to triangulate the data gathered. It is a non-probability technique where participants are selected because they meet the researcher's predetermined criteria relevant to addressing the research question (Given, 2008). The inclusion criteria set by the researchers when selecting the participants is that key informants could be male or female as long as they practice the traditional healings, rituals, and beliefs in their community, which are covered in the scope of the study area. Seventeen informants were identified based on the recommendations of the Tourism Officers and the community elders. They were profiled as follows: TH₁ (46 years old, female), TH₂ (81 years old, female), TH₃ (46 years old, female), TH₄ (82 years old, female), TH₅ (82 years old, female), TH₆ (50 years old, female), and TH₇ (63 years old, female) for the traditional healers, R₁ (58 years old, male), R₂ (45 years old, male), R₃ (64 years old, female), and R₄ (57 years old, male) for the informants of rituals, and B₁ (39 years old, female), B₂ (42 years old, female), B₃ (48 years old, female), B₄ (53 years old, female), B₅ (37 years old, female), B₆ (45 years old, male) represented the informants for the beliefs.

Data Gathering Procedure:

The main instruments in the study are the researchers. In-depth interviews were conducted with the aid of the NCCA forms. Note-taking, video recording, and audio recording were done with the informant's consent. Courtesy visits to the offices of the 16 municipalities and 1 component city were conducted to explain the importance of cultural mapping. Fieldworks were then scheduled and conducted with the help of the Municipal Tourism Officers (MTOs). Ethical considerations were taken with the informants in each municipality by securing informed consent during the interviews. Documentary research was also done to support some of the study's findings.

Data Analysis:

The data gathered through in-depth interviews and documentation using field notes, audio recordings, and video recordings during fieldwork were analyzed using the interactive data analysis models from Miles and Huberman (1994).

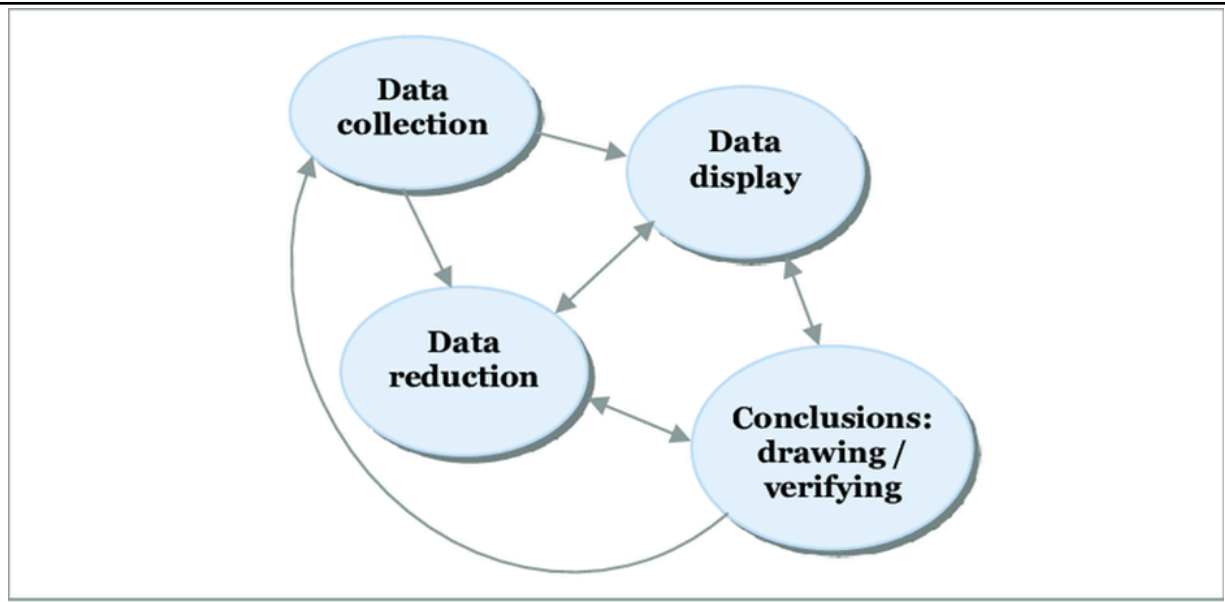


Figure 1. Components of data analysis: Interactive model (Miles & Huberman, 1994, p. 12)

This model has three components: data reduction, display data, and conclusion drawing (verification). The data analysis phase starts after the data were collected. All research data collected were selected (data reduction) by discarding irrelevant information and retaining information relevant to the study, then carefully transcribed.

Then, we display the selected data on traditional healing systems, rituals, and beliefs by organizing and categorizing them according to their types.

Finally, conclusions are drawn to understand the meanings of these cultural items. These conclusions are presented based on the accurate data gathered in the field, their significance, and safeguarding measures taken from the perspective of the local community in Capiz. It then underwent community validation to ensure the correctness of the data.

(12) Results and Discussions

The following are the traditional healing systems, rituals, and beliefs employed by the Capisnon from the accounts of fieldwork through in-depth interviews and observations.

Traditional Healing Systems

1. *Luy-a luy-a*. Luy-a luy-a is a traditional healing technique employed in the rural communities of Capiz, where access to hospitals and medical centers is impossible. Its name is derived from the material used in healing, luy-a (ginger). It is done when a patient experiences severe fever and cold palms (both hand and feet) and is believed to be "ginabugno it kalag," or "troubled by a spirit". The folk healer (mediko, or albularyo) will do the initial rituals called *tayhop* by using a luy-a (ginger)

and *dulaw* (turmeric) to assess the patient with the guidance of the *taglugar* (unseen creatures). From this, the patient's illness and whose soul troubled the patient will be determined. Medication is then prescribed to the patient by putting the following *nilahob* (grilled) ingredients wrapped in the banana leaves: 7 slices of ginger, 7 slices of turmeric, 7 leaves of *alimhon* (*Blumea balsamifera* (L)), and 7 leaves of *argaw* (*Premna odorata* Blanco) into the patient's stomach. It will be done at 8 o'clock in the evening as instructed by the healer and can be untied at 5 o'clock in the morning, and the patient will already be healed. However, the Municipality of Sigma healer applies *badyang* (*Alocasia macrorrhizos* (L.) G Don) leaves with garlic sap to the patient's abdomen for treatment. After the healing session, the patient is instructed to light a candle and pray every night for three days. It is also done to cure headaches and stomach aches. *Sanag* (monetary offering) is then given to the folk healer in exchange for the service rendered, which is part of the healing process.

2. Pamutbot/Pagbulaw. *Pamutbot* or *pagbulaw* in Sigma, Capiz is a traditional way of healing a patient who is believed *ginsabuagan* (being afflicted with illness) by the *taglugar* (unseen creatures). These unseen creatures are the *diwata* (fairy), *kapre* (tree demon), *dwende* (dwarves), *lulid* (look like newborn puppies or piglets that live underground), and other supernatural creatures. The person *nga ginsabuagan* shows some *lapaka* (rashes) on his skin. To verify this, the healer will do the *tayhop* (initial assessment through *luy-a luy-a*) to assess whether the *taglugar* does it and what unseen creatures caused this to the patient. Once verified, the healer will put water in each of the seven leaves of the *payaw* (*Homalomena philippinensis*), then tie and will be encircled on the smoke caused by the *kamangyan* (resin from a tree) in the coconut shell with lit charcoal. This process is called *buok* (fumigation). While doing this, the healer will summon the *taglugar* to ask for forgiveness and to remove the illness given to the person. The *binuok na payaw* will then be placed on the patient's body afflicted with illness. After the ritual, the healer will apply the *lana* (coconut oil with different kinds of small pieces of wood) to the patient's body and give the patient a *panubol* (a dried plant that grows in the sea) to repel the *taglugar*. *Sanag* (an offering of any amount) is then given to ensure the total recovery.

In Sigma Capiz, Once the healer diagnoses the person as "gin sinda," it is time to enact the "pag-bulaw". It is done by placing the burning coal in the coconut shell with *lana* (oil extracted from cooked coconut milk) and *kamangyan* (resin). Then, the healer will fumigate (*buokon*) the *banana* or *bangkal* (*Nauclea orientalis* L.) leaf with the turmeric while reciting a prayer. The healer will then take some of the crushed turmeric and make a cross to the patient's cowlick, forehead, and stomach, then to the nails, arms, and feet, and throw the used turmeric to the west while reciting an *orasyon* (prayer). Medication is then prescribed by prohibiting the patient from washing his/her hands and feet or cleaning his body within 24 hours. Faith and prayer are also needed to ensure the total recovery. However, in Jamindan, Capiz, the *medico* (healer) would ask the patient to hold an egg. If the patient is very ill and cannot come, his used clothes would be brought to the healer. *Buok* (fumigation) using *kamangyan* (resin), *labnog* (*Ficus septica*), and *himboboaya* (Birch flower) plants is then performed.

3. Lumadnong Pagpanambal or Tampol. The *Lumadnong Pagpanambal* is traditionally practiced by the community in Mt. Tagao in Dumarao, Capiz. It is usually done to treat stomach aches. Still, it is also performed to cure various diseases such as *sinda* (manifested by vomiting), *tuyaw* (manifested by intense stomach ache), and other diseases that are said to be incurable even by the

attempts of modern medicine and treatments. The Surhano or folk healer does this indigenous way of treating people; however, it was reported that to this day, there are no more folk healers left in Mt. Tag-ao. However, in the previous Profile of Significant Cultural Properties of the Municipality of Dumarao (2016), they documented the ways and methods of preparation as well as the process of administering herbal medicines, albeit diverse, have common characteristics, as follows:

- a) Infusion is made by pouring boiling water over an amount of the *sibukaw* (*Caesalpinia pulcherrima* (L.) Swartz) herbs to extract its properties. Leaves and flowers are the most suitable parts to use.
- b) A decoction involves simmering the *kaningag* (*Cinnamomum zeylanicum* breyn.) or *biri-bitoon* (*Barringtonia asiatica* (L.) Kurz.) in water to extract its properties. It is suitable for roots or woody parts that do not easily yield their ingredients in a simple infusion.
- c) Compress (warm or cold) applies herbal extracts directly to the skin to reduce inflammation or promote healing. Usually, an infusion or decoction of the *sibukaw* (*Caesalpinia pulcherrima* (L.) Swartz) herb and *kabulay* (beeswax) is prepared for use in the compress, or simply hot or cold water can be used.
- d) Tagulaway (*Parameria laevigata* (A. Juss.) Moldenke) and *salibadbab* (*Crinum asiaticum* L.) are the plants used as poultices that act like a compress. Still, the herb is used rather than a liquid extract. Commonly, poultices are applied hot, and it may be helpful to apply a little oil to the skin to stop the herb from sticking.
- e) The community produces Liniments and essential oils locally, with coconut oil as the base ingredient and added with barks, leaves, and roots of medicinal plants. The oil is used to massage the parts of the ailing body.
- f) Karmen-Karmen is a traditional preventive healing practice that involves putting several parts of plants and other solids in a small container (usually a tiny bag made of cloth that is tightly sewn) and pinning in one's clothes or tying as a belt or even placed in a plastic bracelet.

Although there are no folk healers left that is actively performing the duties of a *Surhano*, the community elder reported to be knowledgeable of the *pagpanambal* or *tampol* processes and is willing to tell the ill individuals how to perform them but does not personally perform them as the informant is not a *surhano* or folk healer by occupation.

4. Traditional Hilot. In the past, especially in far-flung barangays, people couldn't afford hospitalization. They seek first-hand treatment from a *manughilot* (the one performing the hilot). *Hilot* is a traditional healing practice employed by a knowledgeable individual that involves massage, manipulation of joints or bone dislocation, and using herbal remedies to treat various ailments. This is done first by *paghimulso* (checking the patient's pulse) to determine the body

parts that need attention. Then, the *lana*, believed to have a healing effect, is applied to the body parts that need to be massaged. This is still practiced today in the Province of Capiz.

5. Herbal Healing. In the past, plants like ginger, *bunlaw* (*Justicia gendarussa* Burm. f), *labigan* (*Acorus calamus*), and *kusol* (*Kaempferia galanga* L) were used in rituals to help people believed to be troubled by unseen entities. A concoction made from these plants was applied to the person's forehead. If the person reacted strongly to the smell, it was a sign that the treatment was working. The ritual also included prayers; the person usually slept after the treatment. The evil spirit was believed to have left them when they woke up. This healing practice was common in Pontevedra, Capiz and was performed by local healers known as *herbalista* or *medico*.

6. Pagbungga. *Pagbungga* is an alternative cure used to treat gas pains and bloated stomachs, most likely in the rural areas of Capiz. Its name is derived from the word *bunggad*, the material used in doing the *pagbunggad*. *This is done by* blanching the *helba* (*Artemisia vulgaris* Linn.) wrapped in the banana leaf with steam from the newly cooked rice. Once blanched, a pinch of salt is added and squeezed to extract its juices. The extract is then rubbed in the stomach following the cross sign. On the other hand, others use *tilad* (ingredients in *pagmama* or betel nut chewing) to do the *pagbungga*. It is done by chewing the *bunga* (betel nut), *apog* (lime), *tabaco* (tobacco), and *buyo* (betel leaf). The chewed ingredients are rubbed on the patient's stomach and tied to its stomach using the *bawos/bakus/bagkos* (any cloth used to tie the *bungga* on the patient's stomach). The healing process is usually done by the folk healer or any individual who learned the process from a healer.

Rituals

1. Rituals in Farming

a. Panulong-sulong. *Panulong-sulong* is a century-long ritual practice by Sigmahanon (people of Sigma, Capiz) intended to make friends with unseen creatures and souls of deceased persons whom they believe have a significant influence on their lives. It is a method of prayer done all year round and used in the context of farming and other aspects of their lives. The most auspicious day of preparing the field, planting, and harvesting is determined by the spirit they pray to. This is already part of their daily activities for practicing this ritual and still exists today.

b. Bunggad. *Bunggad* is derived from the Hiligaynon word *pamungad*, which means "entrance or start." It is a ritual practice by the farming community in Capiz that initiates the start of rice planting. In the past, it was usually done by the chieftain who could connect with the environment and spirit of the land for protection, growth, and abundance to achieve the maximum vegetative potential of the plants. It is done using the *saha ng saging* (banana pups), *bugnay* (*Antidesma bunius*), *tanglad* (lemon grass), and *panagang* (*Justicia gendarussa*) along with a cross. Once planted, the initiator will cast a prayer, usually in Latin. Then, with the rice seedlings in his hand, he will plant them around the *bunggad*. After that, it is now the signal that the *manugtanom* (farm laborer) can start transplanting seedlings. Moreover, this is also done during *patubas* (harvesting)

seasons. The farm owner or caretaker typically performs this ritual to signal that the harvest begins. The first bundle of cut rice stalks is treated with respect and is carefully placed on top of the cross of the *bunggad* used during the planting season. This will serve as an offering to honor the spirit of the land and is believed to invoke blessings and protection over the entire harvest.

c. Butang-butang /Mahikaw/Pagpanalhong. *Butang-butang* is a ritual practiced by the people of Pontevedra and other neighboring Municipalities in Capiz. Terminologies vary in the different municipalities. The word *butang-butang* is a Hiligaynon, which means "offerings." This is done right after the rice harvest, wherein they cook everything they have to offer, including chicken, fruits, veggies, and root crops, to express their gratitude for the good harvest; some are placed at the altar. Also, rice field owners and their families offer this ritual to their *salaguron*. People sometimes think someone becomes sick or ill because they have forgotten their *salaguron*. *Salaguron* refers to the soul of any departed family member. Others interpret this as enchanted creatures reside in a person's household.

The *medico* (faith healer) initiates the rituals by offering a prayer as preparation. Then, using a spoon, some will play the porcelain or ceramic bowl while the faith healer plays the bajo. To become possessed, others join in the ceremonial dance around the table. They could also dance around the living pig while a bamboo sword or piece of wood is being used to injure it. Following this, the pig is killed or butchered, and its blood has been spread around the house. Subsequently, the faith healer either speaks or distributes coins on the roof and in the vicinity of the individual requesting this ritual. It is forbidden to collect or take any of the scattered coins within a day.

2. Ritual in Fishing

Pahinis. In the past, before a *baruto* (boat) was launched into the sea, the elders performed a ritual called *pahinis*. This practice was believed to ensure an abundant catch and good fortune for the fishermen. The boat owner would offer food, typically by slaughtering a pig or a chicken, to make the fishing easier and more successful. The elders also believed that the first catch in their nets should be released back into the sea to attract more fish to their nets. The ritual involved the sacrifice of a black pig. The blood of the black pig was smeared over the entire body of the boat. After the smearing, a ritual called *buok* (fumigation) for the fishing net and boat used in fishing is performed during Good Friday using the gathered ingredients: 3 blessed dried palm leaves (*lukay*), 3 dried leaves of *salindogok* (*Phlegmariurus magnusianus*), blessed during the Holy Week procession, a three-branched of *banahog* tree, collected on Good Friday, *kamangyan* (resin), collected on Good Friday, *amorsiko* (*Andropogon acicularis* Willd.) grass, *hindalukot* (*Desmodium sp.*), *sapinit* (*Rubus moluccanus* Linn.) with seven accompanying leaves, and *balayan sang anay* (termite mound). Then, at six o'clock on a Friday evening, during a waning moon, they would begin the ritual by splashing the boat's body with *tanglad* (lemongrass) soaked in seawater.

This ritual is still practiced by the fishing community of Ivisan (people of Ivisan) and other neighboring coastal municipalities in Capiz. Doing so would bring luck and ensure a bountiful catch for the fishermen.

3. Rituals in House Construction

a. *Pasad or Tadya.* *Pasad* is a long-standing ritual performed before the house's construction. It was believed that there are also unseen creatures living around us. This is done by following a particular set of procedures to ensure the safety and blessings of the construction site. First, the length and width of the house are measured, and bamboo poles are used to mark the area where the house is going to be built. Next, good *palay* (rice) seeds, a clean coconut shell, a good guava branch, and a cross are prepared. The middle portion of the area is cleaned, and seven seeds of *palay* are covered with a coconut shell, with the cross and guava branch placed beside it. These items serve as markers to prohibit anyone from intruding into the property. For three days after the ritual is performed, the ritual leader must not experience a nightmare or any bad dream, as this would be a bad sign indicating that the *dadalmunon* (or underground spirits) will not allow the house to be built in that area, necessitating a move of the building area and a repetition of the ritual. However, if the ritual leader dreams of something good and abundant, they may proceed to the next step. After three days, the ritual leader should open the coconut shell. If the seeds are scattered, one or more seeds are missing, the coconut shell has been opened, or the cross and guava branch has been moved, it is a bad sign, and the ritual must be repeated in another area. Conversely, if the seeds are complete and have grown, it is a sign that the house construction may continue in that area.

On the other hand, the Dumaraonon (people of Dumarao) community has a difference in doing this, they use *pisi/lubid* (rope) as a marker where the structure will stand. This ritual aims to determine whether any malevolent entities reside in the area where the construction will occur. This will be observed for several days, and if the ropes break, it indicates the presence of a *taglugar*. Consequently, they promptly relocate to another location to ensure the construction process does not disturb unseen elements.

b. *Padaga.* *Padaga* is a ritual that is performed during the construction of a house. It is done by putting coins on each post of the house. These coins are called the *daga* or offering for the unseen creatures that might be disturbed during the construction. Once the construction is done, the owner will butcher a pair of chickens of the same color, let the blood drip off, rub it on each post, and put a sign of a cross with the blood. This ritual of butchering a pair of chickens is also called *padaga*, but others use the term *padugo*. This is done to "avoid a negative occurrence" (*tigbalaw*) during their stay in their newly constructed house. They also believe that it makes the foundation of the house stronger.

4. *Batak Patupad* (Ritual for Aspirant Healer). Becoming a folk healer can be either an innate calling or a pursued aspiration. The "Batak Patupad" ritual is performed for those who aspire to become a folk healer. The chosen one would go through the *pagpatupad* (appointing of the traditional healer) ritual to affirm his/her anointment. After the ritual, the Sorhana or babaylan

(traditional healer) would then be granted the *kinaadman* (power to heal) (Rosales et al., 2022). This elaborate and festive ritual invokes the major gods and goddesses of various realms—*encantadia* (land of fairies), the seas and waters, the forest, and the animals.

The ritual process for aspiring folk healers begins with a thorough spiritual cleansing, where the healer purifies both body and spirit in preparation for the ceremony. To attract nature spirits and other spiritual energies, bells are rung, creating an inviting atmosphere for their presence. The folk healer then calls upon their spirit guides and associated gods to join the ritual.

An altar is prepared, covered in a striking red cloth, and adorned with offerings of unsalted cooked dishes and raw pork and chicken meat to honor the spirits and deities. This altar is set up for a spiritual banquet to please and entertain the visiting spirits. The healer then invokes a hierarchy of deities, including the general and queen of *encantadia*, the king of the forest, the king of the dwarves, the king of the ocean and waters, the king of animals, and other gods and goddesses.

During the banquet, offerings are made to honor and appease the gods, ensuring their favor and blessings. The *babaylan* requests the spiritual visitors to assign a suitable spiritual guardian to the aspiring healer. Following this, the *pagsadsad*, or “spirit possession,” occurs, where the spirit guides temporarily enter the aspirant's body to provide guidance and validation.

Once the spiritual visitors have been thanked and allowed to return to their realms, the *babaylan* performs a final spiritual cleansing of the aspirant, ensuring their readiness and purity. The ritual concludes with the *babaylan* conducting a spiritual healing on themselves, marking the end of the ceremony.

Beliefs

1. *Indi magsampaw sang bahaw sa bag-o tig-ang nga kan-on* (Do not place leftover rice on top of freshly cooked rice). It is believed that by adding leftover rice to freshly cooked rice, the difficulties and undesirable events in life will only worsen and complicate the problem being dealt with. Leftover rice can be separated or prepared as fried rice to avoid wasting food. By following this, it will prevent the occurrence of new problems while dealing with existing ones. This belief dates from their forefathers and is still practiced by the Capisnon (people of Capiz) until today.

2. *Baho sang tayangaw* (Smell of a stinky bugs). This belief started from ancestors who first believed that when they could smell the odor of *tayangaw*, it signals the presence of “*tiktik*” or “*wakwak*,” a bird that eats humans. Once parents could smell the odor coming from this bug, they secured their children to get inside their homes to avoid being taken by these creatures. The odor usually comes during the day's downtime. It is also believed that during that hour, “*tiktik*” or “*wakwak*” were actively waiting for its victim. This belief still exists today as it was passed down from generation to generation through oral transmission and as a form of social control.

3. *Kung magtanom saging dapat may ginatib-ong kag dapat hubas kag busog* (When planting bananas, someone should be carried on your back, and it should be low tide and with full stomach). In the past, people lived as one with nature. Everything being practiced comes from the aboriginal

knowledge they observed, learned, and discovered within their environment, whether fishing or farming. One of their practices handed down from the different generations is a belief in banana planting. When planting bananas, someone should be carried on your back, and it should be done during low tide and on a full stomach so that it will bear healthy and laden fruit. Today, some of the younger generation do not practice this belief because of the presence of new technology in farming.

4. *Pagpanabi-tabi*. Capisnon believes that unseen creatures live in places like *mariit* (sacred or taboo places). This place must be respected or avoided to avoid divine retributions. Often, people venturing within these places must first ask permission from the spirit, which is similar to our concept of *tabi-tabi po* (Talaguit, 2019).

5. *Wedding Belief*. The following are the beliefs before, during, and after the wedding ceremony.

- a. ***Indi pag-isukat ang trahe de buda kung indi pa adlaw sang kasal.***(The wedding dress or “trahe de boda” should not be tried on if it is not yet the wedding day)

Brides adhere to this custom because they believe that trying on the wedding dress before the wedding day could bring bad luck and cause the wedding to be canceled or not proceed as planned. This superstition is based on the idea that certain actions might invite adverse outcomes or disrupt the harmony and auspiciousness of the upcoming marriage.

- b. ***Indi magbyahe kung lapit na ang kasal.*** (Do not travel when the wedding day is near)

This belief that a couple should not travel if their wedding day is near originates from a traditional superstition that suggests that they are more susceptible to accidents during this time. This superstition is based on the idea that negative forces or bad luck might disrupt their plans and cause harm. By avoiding travel, the couple minimizes the risk of unexpected events or accidents that could hinder their wedding plans. This practice is intended to ensure the couple's safety and the smooth progression of their wedding preparations.

- c. ***Dapat indi mapatay ang kandila samtang gaseremonya*** (The candle should not go out during the ceremony). During a wedding, it is crucial to ensure that the burning candles do not go out because there is a belief that whoever's candle extinguishes will be the first to die. To prevent this, great care is taken to ensure the candles remain lit throughout the ceremony. Thus, ensuring the candles stay lit is a way to secure the couple's future and ward off any negative influences or bad luck. This belief is still practiced during wedding ceremonies.

- d. ***Magpusa sang baso sa reception sang kasal*** (Breaking a glass at the wedding reception).

Breaking glass at a wedding reception is often seen as a powerful ritual for ensuring good fortune and protection for the newlyweds. The loud, shattering noise is believed to bring good luck by chasing away negative energy and attracting positive blessings. This act also aims to ward off evil spirits and bad luck that might otherwise impact the couple's future. The sound of the glass breaking is thought to scare away malevolent forces or supernatural entities that could cause misfortune, setting the stage for a future filled with happiness and success.

6. Belief for the deceased (*Panimad-on sa patay*)

The following are the beliefs observed by Capisnon during *bilasyon* (the vigil for the dead) until the funeral.

- a. ***Indi magluto sang mga nagakamang nga pagkaon*** (Do not cook foods that crawl). This belief of not cooking foods that crawl—such as *kalabasa* (squash), *kangkong* (water spinach), *patula* (sponge gourd), *kamote* (sweet potato), *alimango* (mangrove crab), *kasag* (blue swimming crab), etc. is still observed today based on the notion that failing to follow this practice could lead to the death of another family member. The underlying idea is that foods associated with crawling creatures are seen as having negative attributes, which could invite misfortune or further tragedy. Thus, avoiding such foods during the wake is believed to help protect the family and prevent additional loss.
- b. ***Indi pagtulugan ang patay*** (The dead should not be left alone). The older generation believes that "indi pagtulugan ang patay" because the body might be possessed by negative entities and wake up the person guarding it who fell asleep. There must always be at least one person awake to keep watch. This long-standing belief still exists during wakes.
- c. ***Indi magpanudlay*** (Do not comb your hair). This belief is rooted in the older generations and was observed during wakes, for they believed it would cause the remaining family members bad luck.
- d. ***Indi magdala pagkaon halin sa namatyan*** (Do not take home food from the house of the deceased). This belief is strictly observed, with parents constantly reminding the younger generations to refrain from bringing home food from the deceased's house. They believe doing so will bring bad luck to the family that takes the food home.
- e. ***Magtapak sa abo bag-magsulod sa balay kung halin sa namatyan*** (Step on the ashes before entering the house if coming from the house of the deceased). This prevents the departed's soul from entering your home and avoids bad luck. Stepping on the ashes before entering your house is believed to cleanse or protect you from any negative influences associated with the dead.
- f. ***Indi pagpatuluan luha ang lungon sang patay*** (Do not let tears fall on the coffin of the deceased). This belief is based on the idea that allowing tears to fall on the coffin could bring bad luck or disrupt the peace of the deceased's journey to the afterlife.
- g. ***Indi magpanilhig*** (Do not sweep). This belief suggests that sweeping during a mourning period or when a death in the home is thought to bring misfortune.
- h. ***Indi magpanghinguko*** (Do not cut your nails). Cutting your nails during mourning is believed to bring bad luck or disrespect. Thus, observing this could avoid misfortune during sensitive times.
- i. ***Ihaboy ang bayo sang patay sa ibabaw atop para indi mag-ulan*** (Place the clothing of the deceased on the roof to prevent rain). This practice is based on the belief that placing the deceased's clothing on the roof can help prevent rain from falling during the funeral.
- j. ***Magbuka sang gamit o baso bag-o pagwaon ang lungon*** (Break items or glasses before the coffin is taken out). The practice of breaking items or glasses before removing the

coffin is believed to be a way to ward off curses associated with death, aiming to protect the family from experiencing additional losses or misfortunes.

- k. ***Bugtuon ang rosarito nga ginapabalon sa patay*** (Break the rosary beads that are given to the deceased). This practice involves breaking the rosary beads placed with the deceased as part of the burial or funeral rites. The belief behind this action is to symbolically sever the ties between the living and the dead, preventing any negative influences or misfortunes from affecting the surviving family. It is intended to ensure that the deceased's departure does not bring bad luck to those left behind.

Significance of the Traditional Healing Systems, Rituals, and Beliefs

Historical Significance. Traditional healing systems, rituals, and beliefs were already embedded in the culture of Capisnon before the Spaniards came to the Islands. However, in contemporary times, in the accounts of Rosario Cruz-Lucero and Ruchie Mark Pototanon (2018), the rituals are now a blend of Indigenous and Christian elements employed by the *babaylan* who are medical practitioners persist in folk healers *manugluy-a* (ginger-healer) and *siruhano* (surgeon). The Capisnon might consult the folk healer for diseases that Western medicine cannot explain. Chills and fever, for instance, may be interpreted as *kabuno*, or a reprimand given by a dead person to a relative. *Sinda*, manifested by vomiting, and *sabwag*, by itchy lesions on the skin, may be punishment inflicted by supernatural beings. The afflicted person may ask a folk healer to propitiate these beings with offerings.

Aesthetic Significance. The aesthetic significance of the practice lies in the associated objects, flora, and fauna used in the rituals and by the healers. It shows how Capisnon understands and connects with their environment. It is their way of healing a person suffering from diseases afflicted by the *tag-lugar* that causes harm to the patient and other ailments. They also use this as a way to communicate with the spirit of the land or unseen creatures, just like in *luy-a luy-a* and *pamutbot*, along with the prayer chanted by the *medico*. Flora has many ritual uses: protection, abundance, and warding off evil. For fauna, sacrificial animals such as pigs and chickens are used as *daga* (offerings or payment) in rituals like *padaga* and *pahinis*.

Scientific Significance. Traditionally used medicinal plants have recently received attention from the pharmaceutical and scientific communities (Taylor et al., 2001). As such, many studies have already been conducted regarding the plants used by traditional folk healers, and they have been proven to have curative effects.

Social Significance. The practice is considered socially significant since people in rural areas still believe that once they consult the folk healers in their town, they will probably *magaayo* (cured). Hence, the practice still exists. Moreover, these practices were observed as a form of social control among children.

Socio-Economic Significance. Part of the practice is that when someone seeks the diagnosis of a folk healer for a particular disease that they believe cannot be explained by a doctor, they give *sanag* after the healing session to ensure the patient's recovery. The *sanag* is a monetary offering the patient gives to the healer, depending on their *kabubut-on* (own will). In rituals, the family who requested to perform the rituals must also give a monetary offering.

Socio-Political Significance. In pre-Christian times, the *babaylan* (priest or priestess) played an essential political, social, religious, and cultural role. They were advisers to the *datu* and the spiritual and physical healers of the community. They officiated in ceremonies that marked the life cycle of each villager (Cruz-Lucero et al., 2018). In contemporary times, folk healers can exercise their traditional knowledge in the community without restriction. However, their numbers have decreased since no culture bearer is willing to adapt the knowledge and skill regarding healing and rituals.

Spiritual Significance. The traditional folk healers assert they cannot cure patients' ailments alone. They seek guidance from their *salaguron* (refers to the unseen creatures) and their patron saints like Sto Niño, who showed up to them before they became healers.

Table 1. Themes on the significance of the documented traditional practices of Capisnon.

Traditional Knowledge and Practices	Historical	Aesthetic	Scientific	Social	Socioeconomic	Socio-political	Spiritual
Traditional Healing	Learned from the ancestors Passed down through generations	Connection with the environment through association with the flora, fauna, and other associated objects used in the practice.	Use of herbs with healing properties or curative effects.	Connects individuals to their cultural roots..	Provide income to the healer.	No restriction imposed by the LGUs	Sacred connections and holistic well-being.
Rituals	Learned from the ancestors Passed down through generations	Connection with the environment through association with the flora, fauna, and other associated objects used in the practice.	None	Promote social cohesion and collective identity	Provide income to the one performing the ritual.	No restriction imposed by the LGUs	Sacred connections and holistic well-being.
Beliefs	Learned from the ancestors Passed down through generations	None	None	Guidelines for acceptable behavior or social norms. Form of social control	None	None	Sacred connections and holistic well-being.

Safeguarding Measures Taken

According to the culture bearers of these intangible cultural heritage, knowledge, and practices are transmitted through non-formal education. This transmission is done orally and through actual observation. Also, identification, documentation, and research through mapping are essential for its preservation. These imply that the Capisnon have their own way of preserving and conserving their traditional knowledge and practices. Hence, these practices are sustained through the coming generations, which also speaks of the resiliency of every Filipino in general in keeping their cultural heritage intact and sacred.

Table 2. Themes extracted on the Safeguarding Measures for Traditional Practices of Capisnon.

Traditional Knowledge and Practices	Safeguarding Measures
Traditional Healing	• Passed on to the next generations through oral transmission, observation, and non-formal education. • Giving of <i>sanag</i> to sustain the supernatural effects of the healing practice • Documentation
Rituals	• Sharing knowledge and experiences with the community. • Giving of <i>sanag</i> to sustain the supernatural effects of the ritual practice • Documentation
Beliefs	• Passed on to the next generations through oral transmission and observation. • Documentation

(13) Conclusions and Recommendations

Capisnon has different traditional healing techniques, rituals, and beliefs, and some of them have different names depending on the municipalities in which they are practiced. This traditional knowledge, being passed down through various generations, is either at risk or can be lost because the younger generations show less interest in adapting the knowledge and skills.

Calling or vocation as a folk healer is crucial and involves commitment and faith. However, most folk healers in the different towns were already old, and some well-known ones had already died without a culture bearer.

Capisnon healing practices, rituals, and beliefs have their own contextual significance in terms of historical, aesthetic, social, socio-economic, socio-political, and spiritual.

Safeguarding measures are also taken through non-formal education based on actual observation and oral transmission. Efforts like identification, documentation, and research are also made to ensure the continuity of this intangible cultural heritage.

It is recommended that the local government should make an effort to create a comprehensive framework to protect this intangible heritage that their municipality is practicing because it is part of their culture and identity. Also, including this intangible heritage in the textbook that the teachers utilize in teaching social science subjects and other related fields is recommended.

(14) Output (Indicate the specific products, processes or services which the project has produced; quantify when possible.)

- ❖ Compilation of the intangible cultural heritage of Capiz on traditional healing systems, rituals, and beliefs.

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Conducted (Indicate the specific products, activity design, processes or services transferred as extension activities)

(16) Economic Analysis (This should present the direct cost of project implementation, expenses in the production of technology, revenues generated from technology produced, return on investment (ROI) and payback period.

(17) Acknowledgments

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